

CS 4300/5300 Software Engineering

Sprint 0-0: Project Idea

1 Purpose

One person from your team will submit your project idea using the Canvas form. This project idea will be presented in front of the class. Each team will then provide their project preferences during Sprint 0-1.

2 Constraints

Whatever you propose must satisfy all three of these:

- it uses a **database backend**
- it integrates at least one **third-party API**
- it integrates at least one **AI API (separate from the third-party API)**.

You will be building this over four sprints, and another team will act as your customer. This idea should be interesting and fun for another team to work on.

3 Sprint 0-0 Objectives

Requirement	Points
Project title	5 pts
Project description (at least 50 words)	25 pts
Goals (at least 5)	20 pts
Target audience	15 pts
Key features (at least 10)	20 pts
Available APIs (3 free to use, including 1 AI API)	15 pts
Total	100 pts

4 Detailed Requirements

4.1 Project Title (5 pts)

A working title for the application. It can change later.

4.2 Project Description (25 pts)

At least **50 words** describing what the application does.

Describe the **problem**, not just the feature list. “Users can log in and see a dashboard” is a feature. “Students lose track of which assignments are actually urgent” is a problem. Cover the core problem the application solves, who has that problem, and why solving it matters to them.

4.3 Goals (20 pts)

At least **five** specific outcomes the project seeks to achieve.

State outcomes, not activities. “Write the login page” is a task. “A user can recover their account without contacting support” is an outcome.

4.4 Target Audience (15 pts)

Who this is for, described as a **role** rather than a person. Name your primary users and say how they differ from anyone else who touches the system.

4.5 Key Features (20 pts)

At least **ten** features. One line each is fine. These are the raw material for the user stories your customers will write in Sprint 0-2, so favor things a user can observably do over internal implementation details.

4.6 Available APIs (15 pts)

Find **three** APIs that are free to use and could serve your project. For each, name it and state in one line what your application would get from it.

At least **one** of the three must be the **AI API** named in the Constraints above, and at least one must be a non-AI third-party API. Together they have to cover both constraints.

Confirm that each one is actually free at the usage level you need—some APIs are free to sign up for and not free to call. You are not committing to all three; you are demonstrating that your project has a viable integration path.

5 Submission Requirements

Canvas Form (1 submission per team)

Submit through the course project idea form in Canvas. Decide as a team who submits, and make sure the rest of the team has seen the text before it is sent.